

» AFTER

The total number of US women who served in Vietnam is unknown. US Army records are lost, while the Air Force records exist only in paper archives.

LOST TO HISTORY

Many remain unaware that there were American women, other than **nurses**, in Vietnam. They were called liars for wearing the combat patch they had earned, and were subjected to harsh criticism—Specialist Sherri Tipton remembered being called a “baby killer” by protesters. Women faced many of the same struggles as men upon **returning home**.

PROGRESS FOR WOMEN

Military women in Vietnam opened doors for later wars. Congress **disestablished** the WAC as a separate corps in 1978, and women now constitute about 15 percent of the US military. They can qualify for **combat assignments** and serve at all ranks.